

Curricular internships Industrial Experience and Industrial Internship – reporting guidelines for Master in Computer Science students

Information regarding the internship report can be found in the course ECTS file. This document recaps the most important information.

Deadline

The submission deadline is **1 month after the end of your registered internship period** and in any case **latest by October 15**.

Guidelines internship report

The requested report is a technical report, not a diary or holiday essay. The report may be written in English or Dutch.

On this website you can find guidelines for writing a technical report:

<https://eng.kuleuven.be/en/study/engineering-essentials/reporting>

You will see that it states that a technical report may not be written in the first-person tense. The reflection part, which is personal, may be written in the first-person tense.

For the length of the internship report we count the number of words *excluding* title page, table of contents, abstract, administrative data, references and appendices.

For Industrial Experience: a minimum of **4000** words of content.

For Industrial Internship: a minimum of **8000** words of content.

The internship report contains the following elements:

- **Administrative data:** name of student, student's academic year (including option), name and address of internship company, name and contact details (at minimum an e-mail address) of internship supervisor, internship period.
- **Brief description of the company:** in your own words, not a copy-paste from the company website or marketing! Describe the position of this company in the economic market landscape. Indicate potential competitors. Also pay attention to the regional/local context. (max 2 pages)
- **Description of the work done during the internship:**
 - Provide a clear structure to your work plan.
 - Use the correct software terminology.
 - Pay attention, among other things, to the software technology that the company uses. Is the company innovating with technology or not? Reflect.
 - Say something about the guidance you received from the company, the form of guidance, the frequency, ...

- Only for Industrial Internship:
 - Give a detailed description of the partial tasks that have been carried out. This part must refer to the internship plan. Did you set out to do what you had planned, or did you have to adjust?
 - Alternative methods / technologies: The company has made certain choices for its software development (programming language, platform, methodology, software architecture, etc.). Indicate whether your development could have benefited from alternative methods, technologies, etc. Be critical!
- **Relationship between internship and your education programme** (min 1 page, max 3 pages): What content of which courses were useful during the internship? Was this content suitable for what was needed in practice? Be critical!
- **Critical reflection** on the competences that you expected to improve (see clarification further down this document).
- **Conclusions** drawn from the internship: Have the goals of the internship been achieved? Did the internship deliver added value to you? (max. 1 page)
- To add in **appendix**:
 - The list of competences you expected to improve.
 - Only for Industrial Internship: your original internship plan.

Confidentiality

Companies and organizations – rightly – attach great importance to confidentiality. During your internship, you may have signed a confidentiality clause as part of your internship or employment agreement.

Your internship report should give us a clear overview of your tasks and deliverables during the internship, but always do so with due regard for confidential company information. It is rarely, if ever, necessary to include sensitive or confidential information in your report! If you are unsure whether certain information may be included, discuss this with your internship supervisor *before* submitting your report.

Your internship report will only be read by the internship coordinators, and they treat these reports as confidential information.

How to submit?

You must submit your report via Toledo Portfolio, using the form “Eindverslag-CW”.

What happens after submission?

During the first semester, you will be invited to give a brief presentation about your internship to the internship coordinators. Guidelines for the presentation will be provided at the start of the semester.

We will also contact your internship supervisor for brief feedback on your internship.

Don't forget: the evaluation of this course (i.e. the marks you get for it) is done on the basis of this report and the presentation. So pay due attention to the report, and make sure you stick to the form and content we ask for!

What is meant with “critical reflection”?

Reflection is an important part of the report. We know from experience that not everyone understands well what we mean by reflection, so here is a little more explanation.

“We do not learn from experience, we learn from reflecting on experience”
- John Dewey

Reflection means to pause and think critically about your experiences during your internship, reflecting on what you have learned exactly (both on a technical level and on a personal level, the so-called *soft-skills*). Reflection is thinking about your own development, what you learned and the future impact that the experience can have for your personal and professional life. You reflect on your acquired knowledge, attitudes, and skills and you explicitly discuss these in your report.

Do not do this superficially.

For example: Do not just say that you have "learned to communicate better". The question is what you have learned! Perhaps you have gained experience with different types of communication: e.g., with the CEO of the company, with other employees, possibly with other job students, maybe even with customers - these different target audiences require a different kind of communication! You may have experienced a lot of meetings, maybe daily stand-up meetings, maybe you used specific communication tools, these are all things you can reflect on when you talk about communication in your report.

To help you reflect, you already had to compile a list of competencies that you hope to improve during your internship. Most likely there will be competencies that you have learned and that were not in that list. Do not forget to include these in your report! And it may also be that certain competencies that you thought you would learn have not been addressed. You can also discuss these in your report.

It is useful to already think about these competencies *during* your internship and to reflect on this. Our most important advice is to take note of your experiences already during your internship. Don't wait until right before the deadline! You will be thankful to yourself when the time comes to write your report.

Those of you that want a little more guidance can have a look at the Toledo module called “KICK Skills”. This learning module's Chapter 5 (TIPS&TOOLS) contains more practical advice on how to reflect on your experiences.

We wish you every success, and a lot of fun with your internship!
The Internship Coordinators